

Here's a comprehensive FAQ on applying for a UK Visitor Visa from India in 2026:

□ □ **UK Standard Visitor Visa — FAQ for Indian Applicants**

1. Do I need a visa to visit the UK from India?

Yes. Indian passport holders must apply for a **Standard Visitor Visa** to enter the United Kingdom, which covers England, Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland.

2. What can I do on a UK Visitor Visa?

With a UK visitor visa, you can stay in the country for up to 6 months for tourism, to visit friends and family, take up study courses that are less than 6 months, and for specific business-related activities — provided you are not authorized to work in the country.

3. How long is the visa valid?

You can apply for a long-term Standard Visitor visa if you visit the UK regularly. This visa lasts 2, 5, or 10 years. You can stay for a maximum of 6 months on each visit. First-time applicants are typically granted a 6-month visa.

4. When should I apply?

The earliest you can apply is 3 months before you travel. It's recommended to apply at least 3–4 weeks before your planned travel date to allow for processing time.

5. What is the step-by-step application process?

You can follow these steps:

1. Select the visitor visa that best suits your purpose of travel
 2. Apply for the visit visa online via the official UK portal
 3. Arrange the required documents and complete the visa payment online
 4. Schedule an appointment for your biometrics at the nearest VFS Global centre
 5. Submit the visa application along with the documents
 6. Await the visa decision (may take up to 3 weeks)
 7. Once approved, collect your stamped passport
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6. Is there an interview?

Unlike the US system, most Standard Visitor outcomes for Indians are decided on paper and uploads — there is usually no sit-down interview at the TLS/VFS step.

7. What documents do I need?

Key documents include:

- Valid passport (valid for the entire duration of your stay, with at least one blank page)
- Completed online visa application form
- Bank statements (last 6 months)

- Proof of income / employment / business
- Travel itinerary and accommodation details
- Proof of ties to India (job letter, property, family)
- Invitation letter (if visiting family/friends)

You must demonstrate that you are a genuine visitor — showing genuine intention to visit for a permitted purpose and leave at the end of your stay, and sufficient funds to cover all costs without working or accessing public funds.

8. What are the visa fees?

The standard 6-month UK visitor visa fee is £127 (approximately ₹13,462), plus VFS service charges (₹3,000–4,000). Priority service adds £500 for 5–7 working day decisions; Super Priority adds £1,000 for next-day results.

Long-term visa fees: 2 years (£475), 5 years (£848), or 10 years (£1,059).

9. How long does processing take?

UK visitor visa processing time averages 15 working days (~3 weeks) for standard applications, starting from your biometric appointment — not online submission.

10. Where do I submit biometrics in India?

VFS Global visa application centres operate in New Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Chandigarh, Cochin, Goa, Jaipur, Jalandhar, and Pune.

11. How much bank balance do I need?

A solo traveller should have a bank balance of at least ₹4–5 lakhs for a month-long visit, ₹2.5–3.5 lakhs for a two-week stay, and ₹1.5–2 lakhs for a one-week trip. There is no officially fixed minimum, but funds should cover all your expenses.

12. Do I need to book flights before applying?

You are not required to book flights or travel before applying. The UK government advises against booking non-refundable travel until your visa is approved.

13. What is the approval rate?

The approval rate for UK visitor visas from India is approximately 82%. About 18% of applications are refused, most commonly due to insufficient financial evidence or weak ties to the home country.

14. Can I extend my visa once in the UK?

In most cases, you cannot extend a Standard Visitor Visa. You are expected to leave the UK before your visa expires. Extensions are only granted in exceptional circumstances such as medical emergencies.

15. What are common reasons for refusal?

- Insufficient financial evidence
- Weak ties to India (no stable job, property, or family)
- Inconsistent documents (e.g., bank statements don't match income letters)

- Undisclosed previous visa refusals from other countries
- Frequent visits suggesting you're living in the UK rather than visiting

□ **Apply here:** [gov.uk — Standard Visitor Visa](https://www.gov.uk/standard-visa)